

Orientation Class Activity Report

Orientation Class Program No.:

Name of Program	Orientation on Inspection SOP for Partner Organizations			
Venue, Location	HRRP Office, Hotel Gurkha INN, Gorkha			
	GPS			
Date/Time	3 rd Jan 2017/ 1 pm (13:00 hrs)			
Organizing Partners	1. Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform-Nepal (HRRP), Gorkha			
	2. NRA, DLPIU, POs			
No. of Participants (Mention Types and No. eg. Engineer, ward/municipal staff, Social Mobilizer, house owner, volunteer etc.)	Type and No. of Participant			
	NRA	DLPIU	POs staff	Total
		1	19	20
Geographical Coverage				
Resource Persons	Er. Roshan Shrestha (Chief, DLPIU)			
	Er. Minar Thapa Magar (DC, HRRP)			
Counterpart Coordinator				
Activities and Observations				
S.N	Activity		Special Observation	
1	Introduction and Overview of Inspection Process		Partners were very interested to know about inspection process and their roles and responsibilities during inspection process.	
2	Orientation on Inspection SOP		Inspection procedure and institutional guidance was provided to partners through orientation and partners were hoping forward for speed reconstruction through this success.	
3	Detail Discussions on Inspection procedures and Annexes		Open live discussion was very effective to bring on burning field issues and to discuss more about challenges and risks that may be faced during inspection and technical field support process.	
Brief Introduction of orientation, major discussion and reflection of participants.				

Introduction:

Three hours' orientation session on Inspection SOP has been successfully completed at Gorkha district on 3rd January, 2017. Total 17 participants from various partner organizations attended orientation program and actively contributed in discussion and sharing sessions. Orientation was effective for POs to understand inspection process and guideline and open discussions created space to bring up all critical burning issues and challenges from the field.

HRRP Gorkha has been conducting such orientation and training sessions on government guidelines, policies and process from very first day of reconstruction and needs to continue its effort to bring all stakeholders together. Some of the major activities are:

- a. Enrolment ToT for POs (designed and conducted by HRRP)
- b. Enrolment orientation to all Government stakeholders (all VDCs and Municipalities secretary and social mobilizers)
- c. Orientation to all recruited DLPIU technical persons on enrolment, reconstruction guideline and technical demonstrations.

Major Discussion issues:

1. Compliance and Technical assistance
 - Based on POs observation and experience, houses which has already been reconstructed or in process of reconstruction will not comply to checklist and they won't be eligible to get second tranche as most of people won't retrofit or improved it as suggested by inspection team due to insufficient budget.
 - House owners and trained masons were not supported and prepared with knowledge and idea about minimum requirements during 7 days skilled mason training and household level orientations.
 - Everybody are using 10 key messages for Household level orientations and skill trainings but it doesn't give full package information of minimum requirements for all components of earthquake resistant house. Vertical post, corner, joint stitches and many more information are not included in commonly agreed 10 key messages.
2. Additional designs and limitation of building codes regarding mixed designs and hybrid structures
 - Northern houses in Gorkha district are constructed with dry stone masonry and timber, but there are no any inclusive guidelines for such type of construction either in inspection guideline or in Nepal building codes.
 - More than 80 percent of houses in Northern Gorkha has already been reconstructed as they had to withstand cold and snow and they couldn't wait for government guidelines and it will be one of the major challenges for inspection and supervision team to suggest any other improvement and retrofitting options.
 - People are also improvising and up taking new learned technology and knowledge to different levels by creating a hybrid structures and there is no way to incorporate those designs and mixed technology into national standards and guidelines. People are building up timber and CGI structures in top of one storey stone mud masonry building, people are building up steel frame structures and how can they get compliance as they may be earthquake resistance building?
 - We have heard of second sets of design from government and still could not access it after several months. Do all those designs will cover up other technologies and hybrid construction?
 - Most of the people constructed their housed by connecting two houses together, will they be eligible for second tranche?
 - People don't have money and can people go for timber banding with stone cement mortar? Similarly, people wants construct plinth band with RCC and rest of the band with timber as in this way timber can be protected from termites?
3. Awareness Campaign and orientation on inspection process to community
 - Every field staff and technical support team should be orientated on inspection guideline and process so that they could support communities and beneficiaries during the process by making them aware of their right to get technical support and their responsibilities to fill up forms / application as mentioned in inspection SOP.
 - People won't fill up forms for multiple times as they are already frustrated by government policies and we POs need to support and facilitated this process to make them aware and to influence them to access their facilities and rights.
 - Information or message should be formulated in very easy way so that every people in the community will understand the process easily and will teach other themselves. Inspection process should be explained in

easy and practical way so that educated and smart people from community can teach others within the community.

4. Constructions materials and quality
 - Treatment and seasoning of timber is also one of the major challenge and there are no any guidelines for type of wood to be used in bandings. Only soft wood and medium type of wood are available in middle and norther zone of Gorkha. Can we use any type of wood for banding and use some local treatment method? In some northern VDCs no any construction type of timber are available, what could be other option for seismic band?
5. Special support should be provided to vulnerable household during the process and also for the construction as they don't have capacity to add up and construct earthquake resistant house as per inspection guidelines.
6. When will government release retrofitting guideline? As dry stone retrofitting should also be incorporate in that guideline to address northern issues and challenges.
7. POs roles and responsibilities and way forward
 - POs will focus more on door to door assistance and mobile technical support as Technical support team and will start supporting beneficiaries as soon as possible based on inspection guideline.
 - Some partners like CARE and CRS already oriented all of their staffs and started to plan for managing technical support team and also planned for establishing hotline no. within some VDCs or cluster to provide technical support through call and to coordinate and supervise demand of technical support.
 - Coordination and cooperation between POs and DLPIU technical persons should be strengthen for uniform partnership inspection process. A proper coordination system needs to be introduced between DLPIU engineers, POs staff and VDC secretary for smooth and coordinated inspection process.
 - POs need to orient inspection process to beneficiaries and provide technical support to people and make them aware about minimum requirements.

Problems	• Session was short and theoretical and there were many issues which couldn't be addressed during the session.
Lessons	• This type of orientation must continue as it gives clear picture to different stakeholder and helps to create common understanding among POs and government. Discussion session also provides platform to share different queries, challenges from the field and helps to communicate and share technical risks and work on it together.
Follow-up Action	• Retrofitting guidelines

Following documents are attached with this report;

1. Registration of Participants
2. Representative Photographs

Participants Registration Sheet

Photographs

Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP)		Inspection SOP Guideline Orientation				
		3rd Jan 2017				
		1 PM, Hotel Gorkha Inn				
#	Org.	Name	Title	Mobile	Email	Signature
1	OXFAM	Raju Shiwakoti	Shelter officer	9851032413	Rshiwakoti@oxfam.org.uk	
2	INF-Nepal	Heera Vignanshetti	CBR officer	9846845413	Heera.Vignanshetti@inf-nepal.org	
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10	Asahi Chikankara	Bijaya K. Shrestha	Project Coordinator	9813166203	bijayashrestha@asahi.org.np	
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16	HRRP	Mina Thapa	District coordinator	9841076869	Mina.thapa@hrrp.org	
17	SDSC	Surekh Karki	Shelter coordinator	9868318041	surekhkarki123@gmail.com	
18	SVI	Ashim Niraula	Technical officer	9841830169	ashim.niraula@svi.org.np	
19	CWW/UNNepal	Vivek B. Singh	P.C	9851125136	VBP.unnepal@gmail.com	
20	Prati Bikas	JEEWAN SINGH	WASH COORDINATOR	9841070806	sasgorkha@gmail.com	

